Ford Motor Company

James P. Vondale, Director
Automotive Safety Office
Environmental & Safety Engineering

August 19, 2002

Mr. Kenneth N. Weinstein
Associate Administrator for Safety Assurance
National Highway Traffic Safety Administration
400 Seventh Street, S.W.
Washington, D.C. 20590

Dear Mr. Weinstein:

Re: Ford Motor Company (Ford) Recall No. 02L10 – 2000 Model Year Ford Expedition and Lincoln Navigator 4x2 - Incorrect Rear Tire Pressure Information

This is to inform the agency that Ford will conduct a compliance recall program on certain 2000 model year Ford Expedition and Lincoln Navigator 4x2 vehicles to correct the rear tire pressure listed on the Certification Label. The label indicates a rear tire pressure of 30 psi instead of the recommended 33 psi.

Summary

- Ford Action -- Ford is conducting a compliance recall program involving 2000 model year Ford Expedition and Lincoln Navigator vehicles built from March 31, 1999 through August 6, 2000, to provide the correct recommended tire pressure for the rear tires of the affected vehicles.
- Number of Vehicles Involved – Approximately 81,774 vehicles (80,254 in the United States and Federalized Territories, 0 in Canada and 1,520 in other countries).
- Affect on Vehicle Operation – Customers may inflate their rear tires based on the incorrect tire pressure information on the Certification Label.
- Service Procedure – A supplementary label will be sent to customers to place near the Certification Label to identify the appropriate rear tire pressure for the affected vehicles.

Attached is the detailed information required by the applicable portions of 49 CFR Part 573 – Defect and Non-Compliance Information Report.

Sincerely,

James P. Vondale

Attachment
02L10 5d/sls/

ATTACHMENT

49 CFR Part 573 – NON-COMPLIANCE INFORMATION REPORT
02L10 – 2000 MODEL YEAR FORD EXPEDITION AND LINCOLN NAVIGATOR

Pursuant to Part 573 of Title 49 of the Code of Federal Regulations, Defect and Noncompliance Reports, Ford Motor Company (Ford) submits the following information concerning a recall program that it is voluntarily initiating.

573.5 (c) (2) -- Potentially Affected Vehicles

All 2000 model year Ford Expedition and Lincoln Navigator 4x2 vehicles built from March 31, 1999 through August 6, 2000 at the Michigan Truck Plant are potentially affected.

Because these vehicles are not produced in VIN order, information as to the applicability of this program to specific vehicles can best be obtained by either calling Ford's toll-free line (1-800-392-3673) or contacting a local Ford dealer, who can obtain specific information regarding the vehicles from the Ford On-line Automotive Service Information System (OASIS) database.

573.5 (c) (3) -- Estimated Population of Vehicles Potentially Affected

80,254 Ford Expedition and Lincoln Navigator 4x2 vehicles.

573.5 (c) (4) -- Estimated Percentage of Affected Vehicles with the Condition

100%.

573.5 (c) (5) -- Description of the Reason for the Action

FMVSS 120 S5.3.1, requires the label to indicate the recommended cold inflation pressure for the vehicle tires. The rear tire pressure is incorrectly listed on the label for 4x2 vehicles.

573.5 (c) (7) – Basis for Non-Compliance

On July 25, 2002 during discussions with Continental Tire regarding tire performance issues, it was noted that Certification Labels with incorrectly specified rear tire pressures had been observed on some vehicles. An investigation was undertaken to confirm the observed condition and to determine the affected vehicles and vehicle model years. On August 16, 2002, it was determined by Ford that incorrect rear tire label information existed on and was limited to 2000 model year 4x2 vehicles. A tire on an affected vehicle could be overloaded by 107 pounds if inflated to 30 psi while the rear axle of the vehicle was loaded to maximum GAWR.

573.5 (c) (8) -- Service Program

Customers will be mailed a supplemental label to be placed near the Certification Label to identify the appropriate rear tire pressure. Customers will be given the opportunity to have the label installed by the dealer at no cost if a customer does not feel comfortable installing the label.

573.5 (c) (9) -- Press statement and Dealer/Owner Letters

Ford plans to make a public statement concerning the subject matter of this program. Dealer Notification letters and customer Notification letters will be sent out within 30 days. A copy of the Notification letters to dealers and owners from Ford will be forwarded when available.

573.5 (c) (11) -- Recall Number

Ford has assigned recall number 02L10 to this program.